

This deploys the contract to the blockchain.

Interact with the contract: Open the Truffle console to interact with the deployed contract:

```
truffle console --network development
```

In the console, get the deployed contract instance:

```
let instance = await MyFirstContract.deployed();
```

Check the initial message:

```
let message = await instance.message();
console.log(message); // "Hello, World!"
```

Change the message:

```
await instance.setMessage("New Message!");
```

Check the updated message:

```
message = await instance.message();
console.log(message); // "New Message!"
```

Test your contract (optional): To ensure your contract works as expected, write tests in the *test* folder. Create a file *myFirstContractTest.js*:

```
const MyFirstContract = artifacts.require("MyFirstContract");
```

```
contract ("MyFirstContract", () => {
  it("should store and update message", async () => {
    const instance = await MyFirstContract.deployed();
    let message = await instance.message();
    assert.equal(message, "Hello, World!", "Initial message is incorrect");
  });
});
```

```
await instance.setMessage("Test Message");
message = await instance.message();
assert.equal(message, "Test Message", "Message was not updated");
});
});
```

Run the tests:

```
truffle test
```

Where to practice Solidity

You've learned the basics, written your first smart contract, and even deployed it locally—what's next? Like any skill, mastering Solidity takes consistent practice. Luckily, there

are several beginner-friendly platforms where you can experiment, test, and even play games to sharpen your smart contract skills.

Here are some top platforms to help you level up.

Remix IDE: Remix is a web-based Solidity development environment. It requires no setup, making it perfect for quick experiments, learning, and testing your code in the browser. It supports compiling, deploying, and debugging smart contracts all in one place.

- No installation required
- Built-in Solidity compiler and deployer
- Ideal for both beginners and pros

CryptoZombies: CryptoZombies is a fun, gamified platform where you learn Solidity by building your own zombie-themed game. Each lesson introduces new concepts in an engaging and visual way.

- Great for complete beginners
- Teaches Solidity through game-building
- Step-by-step, interactive format

EthFiddle: EthFiddle is like a 'JSFiddle' for Solidity. It lets you write and share Solidity code snippets with others. You can quickly test contracts and collaborate on ideas without leaving the browser.

- Lightweight and simple
- Easy sharing of contract examples
- Good for bite-sized experimentation

Alchemy and Infura (for testnet deployment): When you're ready to go beyond local development, tools like Alchemy and Infura allow you to connect to Ethereum testnets like Goerli or Sepolia. These platforms act as blockchain infrastructure providers and help you interact with real networks—without spending real ETH.

- Deploy contracts to live testnets
- Use test ETH for experimenting
- Helpful for simulating mainnet deployment conditions

Final thoughts

Congrats! You've learned the basics of Solidity and how it powers smart contracts in the blockchain world. Whether you're building DApps, exploring DeFi, or creating NFTs, Solidity is at the heart of many Web3 innovations.

But don't stop here—practice is key. Start writing your own smart contracts, deploy them locally, and experiment with platforms like Remix IDE, CryptoZombies, and Alchemy. The more you build, the better you'll get.

Web3 is full of possibilities, and with Solidity, you're ready to create your own. So, take the leap and start building your part of the blockchain revolution today! 

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